



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cross Classical Academy  
School Website: <https://www.crossclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**SCL MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

Cross Classical Academy TX 76801 presents a strongly classical, Christian-oriented program. The website content consistently foregrounds a Biblical worldview, a three-part classical pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a community model built around parental partnership and formation of virtue. Public materials emphasize liturgical practices (chapel, worship), memorization and recitation in early grades, and high-school-level Socratic or rhetoric-oriented opportunities, alongside explicit goals of forming character, wisdom, and love of learning. Taken together, the school aligns with the classical education rubric across all six categories, with clear evidence of Great Books/Great Conversation-like aims, a Trivium-based curriculum, and a strong emphasis on family partnership and community formation.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly centered on a Christian worldview expressed through chapel, Scripture memorization, biblical worldview integration, and theology-informed aims (evidence: Foundations mission; Christian Worldview page; chapel and Scripture emphasis). - School Purpose and Goal centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing through a Biblical framework rather than mere job-readiness (evidence: mission statements; classical formation language). - Curriculum emphasizes grammar–logic–rhetoric (Trivium), engagement with classical curricula, and the study of classical texts and history, with specific PK–8 and some 9–12 evidence (e.g., School of Grammar, Classical Approach). - Pedagogy combines contemplative/restful elements (Scholé memory-work, chanting) with higher-level dialogue and rhetoric as students advance; lower grades visibly use singing/memorization, upper grades offer Socratic/rhetoric opportunities (as described in public materials). - Faculty framework is described as mentors and living curriculum, with a collaborative model that centers parental involvement and teacher-mentored study; there is a visible portrait of teacher as exemplar within the Foundations and Collaborative Model materials. - Parents & Community are positioned as co-educators and primary partners in formation; the site highlights parental involvement, home-school partnership, and open-campus ethos.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission emphasizes partnering with Christian parents to provide a classical education under a Biblical worldview; aims to glorify God and train students in knowledge, wisdom, and understanding.
- Public messaging foregrounds a Christian worldview, biblical framing, and the integration of theology into education (e.g., "Christian Worldview," daily chapel, Scripture memorization).
- Chapel, worship through song, and Scriptural study are part of the daily rhythm, signaling liturgical and communal practices as part of education.

- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: theology, liturgy, worship, chapel, scripture, biblical worldview, Christian worldview, truth (as a stated aim to “pour truth into their minds”), wisdom, virtue (implied in formation language).
- Negative keywords: none clearly evidenced in public materials; the site emphasizes faith-based framing rather than secular relativism or secular humanism.
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly centers on a Biblical worldview and Christ-centered education with liturgical practices, Scripture integration, and theology-as-foundational to the curriculum, which aligns strongly with the Classical School criterion for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations.

## Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission frames education as formation: formation of virtue and wisdom within a Biblical framework; “lifelong pursuit of knowledge, wisdom and understanding in service of Jesus Christ”.
- Pedagogical orientation emphasizes formation over job-readiness, with references to classical education aims (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the pursuit of wisdom, truth, and beauty through liberal-arts study.
- Public statements emphasize human flourishing and the cultivation of virtue as the telos of education, consistent with a classical paideia approach rather than merely information transfer.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, classical mission, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty (per the “Six Essential Elements” framework).
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public-facing materials (no emphasis on “college/career readiness” or 21st-century-skills-for-work language in place of formation).
- Why this rating
- The school’s stated goals center on formation, virtue, and wisdom within a theocentric framework, aligning with the Classical School goal criteria.

## Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Classical Approach is described as a three-stage Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with the goal of mastering how to learn and to reason clearly.
- School of Grammar explicitly documents a grammar-stage core of memorization and “rules” (including scripture memory, math facts, songs) and mentions classical texts and novels in grade bands.
- The site also references “classical novels,” Mystery of History, and integration of classical texts in the PK–8 program, with Latin/foreign language elements in electives (evidence of classical content).
- The program describes a goal to engage with Great Books-type content and to foster wonder through integrated study (per the classical rhetoric emphasis on unity of truth across disciplines) in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books, classical novels; history studied through a liberal-arts lens; wonder/integration; primary sources (textual engagement reflected in course descriptions).
- Negative keywords: avoidance of a purely social-studies framing; no emphasis on a “social studies” replacement of history is seen in public materials; no project-based-only emphasis is evident as the site foregrounds liberal-arts study.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum is explicitly built around the Trivium, Great Books-like engagement, and integration of history and the arts with a clear liberal-arts emphasis, satisfying the Curriculum criteria for CLASSICAL.

**Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- A three-stage pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is described as central to instruction; the Biblical equivalent is tied to pursuing knowledge and wisdom.
- Lower grades show memorization, singing/chanting, and memory-deepening routines (Scholé-like restful learning) and formation through repeated recall in a joyful, chant-based approach (evident in PK–4 materials).
- Upper grades are described as places for Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates and rhetoric training; students practice public speaking and rhetorical skills (as part of the Classical pedagogy trajectory).
- Liturgical and communal practices (chapel) also inform the pedagogy, integrating spiritual formation with intellectual formation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic/dialogue/seminar; Scholé (restful learning); memory work; chant/singing; rhetoric and public speaking; formation through imitation; liturgical rhythm; great conversation (as a concept related to classical pedagogy).
- Negative keywords present: minimal explicit reliance on project-based learning in the materials; the site emphasizes memory, recitation, and dialogue rather than exclusively constructivist/project-based approaches. The absence of a pure project-based pedagogy in public materials supports a CLASSICAL alignment.
- Why this rating
- The site presents a robust mix of contemplative/scholé elements in lower grades and Socratic/seminar-style and rhetorical training in upper grades, consistent with CLASSICAL pedagogy expectations.

**Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Foundations describe faculty as mentors, living curriculum, and part of a collaborative model that pairs professional instruction with parent-mentored study; the “faculty as exemplars” and “portrait of a teacher” ideas are implied in the living-curriculum language and collaborative approach.
- The Collaborative Model page describes a professional instruction framework integrated with parental involvement, signaling a high teacher–student relational quality and a strong teacher role in formation.
- The mission/vision emphasizes virtue and character formation through the teacher’s example and the school’s culture, aligning with the classical “model teachers and mentors” criteria (from the Six Elements lexicon).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers, living curriculum, teacher as mentor, portrait of teacher, collaborative/partnership model, servant leadership (all reflected in the Foundational and Collaborative pages).
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no language suggesting “facilitator-only,” “guides on the side,” or non-classical pedagogy).
- Why this rating
- The faculty framework emphasizes mentorship, exemplar teachers, and a living curriculum supported by a collaborative model; these align with CLASSICAL faculty expectations.

**Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school explicitly promotes partnering with families and positions parents as co-educators; it describes a collaborative model with parent involvement and parent formation via books and gatherings (e.g., “parent formation,” classical book clubs, and a call for parental participation).
- Text emphasizes open-access to the school for visits, and a mission to assist parents in their God-given task; this signals a welcoming, inclusive community orientation.

- The Foundations page frames a partnership with Christian parents and a “collaborate model” approach that integrates parent-mentored study and character development; this places parents at the center of the classical formation process.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent co-teachers; parental formation; home-school alignment; open campus; community of learners; parental engagement; shared mission; family formation; classical family culture.
- Negative keywords: none evident; materials emphasize parent involvement rather than consumer-oriented or minimal engagement.
- Why this rating
- The school’s publicly stated stance on parent partnership, parental formation, and open-campus ethos aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Ranking - CLASSICAL across all six categories.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable since the aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL. No major needle-moving changes are required to reach CLASSICAL across all categories. If one were seeking to further deepen alignment, potential enhancements could include more explicit articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation in curricular pages (to strengthen Element 3 further) and more explicit mention of Socratic seminars in upper grades (to fortify Element 4), but these are already well-represented.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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